

Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Old Path Song

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: learning from elders.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

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For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

The old ones know things we still need, and it is never too late to go back and ask.

Say it together

Ka-tum, ka-tum.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
path	a little track you walk along	walk two fingers across your arm
landmark	something you can see that helps you find your way, like a big rock or a tree	point far away
dusty	full of tiny bits of dry dirt in the air	wave a hand in front of your face
fetch	to go and get something and bring it back	reach out and pull back to your chest
beat	a steady sound you can follow, like a drum	tap ka-tum on your knee

A gentle note

Some children don't have grandparents nearby, or have lost one. Widen it to 'an older person you know': a neighbour, an aunt, a teacher.

Keep the hunger in the story gentle: the animals are hungry for a short time and there is plenty for everyone at the end.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Ama

White-bellied (tree) pangolin

Loves everything new, and learns to go back



Kwesi

Demidoff's dwarf galago (bushbaby)

Ama's partner for finding new paths



Nana

White-bellied pangolin (grandmother)

Keeps the old song and knows the way



The hornbill

Yellow-casqued hornbill

The big bird who needs the fig tree



The little antelopes

Maxwell's duikers

Hungry little antelopes who follow the beat



The monkey family

Lowe's monkeys

Fig fans in the high branches

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How did they feel?

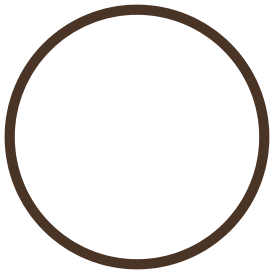
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Ama loves new paths and games.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

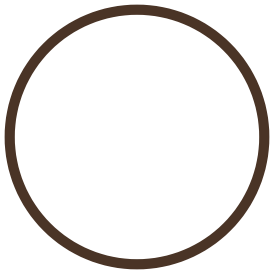


Moment 2

Ama really listens; Nana says the song came from her own Nana.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

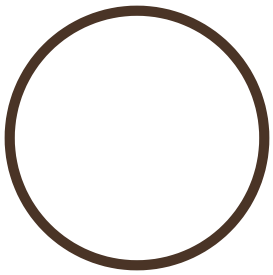


Moment 3

The old song becomes a new clapping game.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

path a little track you walk along

path path

landmark something you can see that helps you find your way, like a big rock or a tree

landmark landmark

dusty full of tiny bits of dry dirt in the air

dusty dusty

Ama the hero of the story

Ama Ama

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Ama showed learning from elders. Draw a time when you showed learning from elders too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Ask an elder

You need: The family note

Children ask a grandparent or an older person at home for a song, game or saying from when they were little. Share them at circle time and make a class book of ‘old things we still need’.

Ask an elder

Ask a grandparent or older friend for a song, game or story from when they were little. Learn it, then teach it to someone new.

Make a pangolin

Cut paper scales and glue them on overlapping, like a pinecone. Can your pangolin roll up?

Bushbaby leap

Mark 2 metres on the floor. That's how far a tiny galago leaps between branches!

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Old Path Song are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Ama

White-bellied (tree) pangolin

The word pangolin comes from the Malay word penggulung, which means "roller".



Kwesi

Demidoff's dwarf galago (bushbaby)

A Demidoff's galago can leap 1.5 to 2 metres between branches without losing height. Its arms land first, like shock absorbers.



Nana

White-bellied pangolin (grandmother)

The baby pangolin rides on the base of its mother's tail while she looks for ants.



The hornbill

Yellow-casqued hornbill

Yellow-casqued hornbills listen to Diana monkeys' alarm calls, and can tell the monkeys' "eagle!" call from their "leopard!" call. That matters: eagles hunt hornbills, but leopards don't.

Story or real?

Tree pangolins really do climb, roll up and eat only ants and termites. But they mostly come out at night, they live alone, and Ama's golden tail scale and her drumming beat are our story's ideas.

Where they really live

The story takes place in a forest in southern Ghana. We picked Kakum National Park, a protected rainforest near the coast where pangolins, bushbabies, hornbills, duikers and Lowe's monkeys all live.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-old-path-song

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What kind of animal is this? Have you ever seen one? What do you notice about her scales and her tail?

The Old Path Song, talk card 1

Why did Ama think the old song was boring?

The Old Path Song, talk card 2

How did she feel when she couldn't remember it?

The Old Path Song, talk card 3

What new ideas did Ama add to the old song?

The Old Path Song, talk card 4

Who in your family knows old songs or stories?

The Old Path Song, talk card 5

What would you like to ask a grandparent or an older friend?

The Old Path Song, talk card 6

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Learning from elders hero

This is to say that

_____

showed learning from elders, just like Ama.

Ka-tum, ka-tum.

Signed _____ Date _____

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